

Pen Tool Quick Reference

FDD 4.2 · DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS

NAME _____

DATE _____



Click = Corner Point

A single click places a corner point, the path changes direction sharply here, no curve.



Click-Drag = Smooth Point

Click and drag out direction handles to place a smooth point, the path curves continuously through it.



Alt/Option-Drag a Handle

Breaks a smooth point's linked handles so the curve can change direction sharply right after it (a "combination corner").



Convert Anchor Point Tool

Click a smooth point to make it a corner, or drag out of a corner point to give it curve handles.



Add/Remove Anchor Point

Click directly on a path with the Pen tool to add a point; click an existing point to remove it.



Close a Path

Hover back over your very first anchor point (a small circle appears next to the cursor) and click to close the shape.

Practice checklist: check off each as you complete it during today's guided practice:

1. A straight-sided shape using only corner points (for example, a triangle or star). ____
2. A single smooth curve (like a wave) using two smooth points. ____
3. A shape combining both corner and smooth points on the same path (for example, a leaf or a shield). ____